Second, India's roads and seas were more permanently integrated with the consolidation of Turko-Afghan imperial power in northern India through different rulers of the Delhi Sultanate (1206-1526), and then the Mughal Empire until the 18th century.[52] With Delhi as the centre of political authority and its vassals spread over a large distance, north–south, east–west and trans-Himalayan routes opened up further. More importantly, the expansion of the northern empires to the seas on both sides of the subcontinent opened up maritime trade by directly connecting the ports to the hinterland. In 1498, Portuguese explorer Vasco da Gama arrived in south India, sailing from Portugal via the Cape of Good Hope in southern Africa, and opened a new route for Europeans to trade with Asia. Followed by the English, Dutch, French and even Danish merchants, Indian goods produced in the hinterlands, especially textiles, received a global market, ushering the migration of artisans and craftspeople towards textile centres. In the 17th and 18th centuries, another major realm of circulation straddled across the three powerful Muslim-ruled empires—Mughal (India), Safavid (Iran) and Ottoman (Turkey)—by land and sea.[53] Surat, a commercial port in western India, grew to be one of the largest cities in the country in the 17th century, housing numerous groups in trade, including the English, Dutch, Arabs, Persians, Turks, Armenians, Jews, Brahmins, Rajputs and Banias.[54] Before the rise of Surat, the largest cities of India were typically inland. With the establishment of English posts in Calcutta, Bombay and Madras in the 17th century, they too would grow to be among the largest cities of the subcontinent by the 20th century, indicating a major spatial shift in the concentration of economic activities to the coasts, thereby spurring coast-bound migration. From the coasts, Indians themselves began leaving for distant shores as lascars (sailors) and ayahs (nannies) to England, or even as Tamil teachers to Germany in the early 18th century.[55] Growing European contact led to a new word being used to refer to outsiders in India. Yavana and mleccha gave way to *firangi* in Persian, the language of the Mughal Empire, to denote foreigners from Europe. The word came from the root word 'franks', an ancient Germanic tribe.[56] It continues to be used to describe foreigners, mostly white, even today.